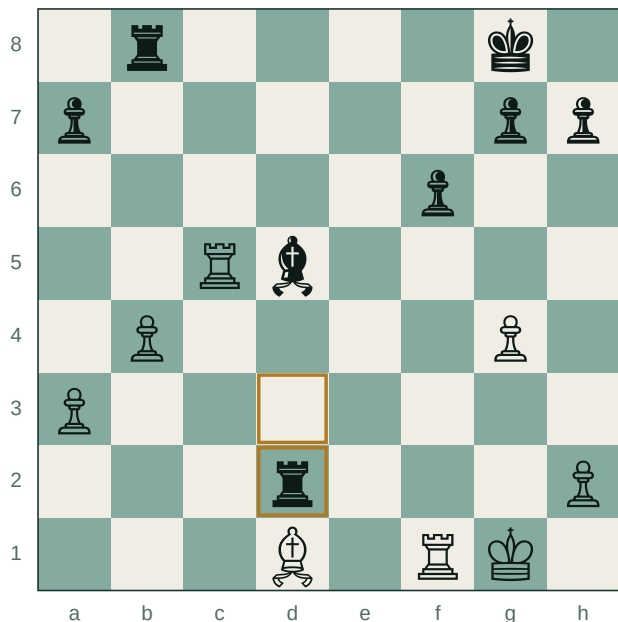


# Pins and pressure: White, move 35

Pins and pressure

White to move



Previous move: 34...Rxd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**35. Rxd5 Rxd5 36. Bb3 Kf8 37. Bxd5**

**35.Rxd5** The rook captures the bishop on d5. Recorded reply: **35...Rxd5**.

**36.Bb3** The bishop moves from d1 to b3. Recorded reply: **36...Kf8**.

**37.Bxd5** The bishop captures the rook on d5.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8 and rook on d2. Check for tactical protection.